

Field studies

- Field studies are done in natural settings.
- “In the wild” is a term for prototypes being used freely in natural settings.
- Aim to understand what users do naturally and how technology impacts them.
- Field studies are used in product design to:
 - identify opportunities for new technology;
 - determine design requirements;
 - decide how best to introduce new technology;
 - evaluate technology in use.

Technology for context-aware field data collection



Figure 14.7 An example of a context-aware experience sampling tool running on a mobile device

Source: From Cogdill, K. (1999) "MedlinePlus Interface Evaluation: Final Report". Reproduced by permission of Prof. Keith Cogdill.

An in the wild study: UbiFit Garden



Figure 14.8 UbiFit Garden's glanceable display: (a) at the beginning of the week (small butterflies indicate recent goal attainments; the absence of flowers means no activity this week); (b) a garden with workout variety; (c) the display on a mobile phone (the large butterfly indicates this week's goal was met)

Source: From Consolvo, S., McDonald, D.W., Toscos, T. et al (2008) "Activity sensing in the wild: a field trial of UbiFit garden". In: *Proceedings of CHI 2008*, ACM Press, New York, p. 1799.

Data collection & analysis

- Observation & interviews
 - Notes, pictures, recordings
 - Video
 - Logging

Data presentation

- The aim is to show how the products are being appropriated and integrated into their surroundings.
- Typical presentation forms include:
 - Vignettes,
 - Excerpts,
 - Critical incidents,
 - Patterns, and narratives.